

Reporting Verbs for Assertive Sentences

Assertive sentence (वाक्यवाक्य वाक्यवाक्य) is a sentence that states a fact, opinion, thought, information, belief, or feeling. In indirect speech, **said/told** are not always the best choices; the reporting verb can be changed according to the meaning of the statement.

1. General Statement / वाक्यवाक्य वाक्यवाक्य

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning	Example
said	वाक्यवाक्य / वाक्यवाक्य	He said that he was tired.
stated	वाक्यवाक्य / वाक्यवाक्य वाक्यवाक्य	He stated that he was innocent.
declared	वाक्यवाक्य वाक्यवाक्य	He declared that he was ready.

announced	□□□□□ □□□	The principal announced that the school would remain closed.
remarked	□□□□□□□ □□□	He remarked that the movie was interesting.
observed	□□□□□□□ / □□□□□□□ □□□	She observed that the road was unsafe.
mentioned	□□□□□□ □□□	He mentioned that he had met Ram.
added	□□□	He added that he would help us.

2. Giving Information / □□□□□ □□ □□□□□□□ □□□□□

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
informed	□□□□□□□ □□□
notified	□□□□□ □□□
reported	□□□□□□□ / □□□□□□□ □□□
explained	□□□□□□□□ □□□
described	□□□□□ □□□
related	□□□□ / □□□□ □□□□□

communicated	□□□□□□□□ / □□□□□□ □□□
revealed	□□□□□□ □□□
disclosed	□□□□□ □□□□ □□□□□

Example:

Direct: He said, “The meeting will begin at ten.”

Indirect: He **informed us that** the meeting would begin at ten.

Nepali: □□□□ □□□□ □□ □□□ □□□□ □□□□ □□□□□□□ □□□□□

3. Giving an Opinion / □□□□□ □□ □□□ □□□□□□ □□□□□

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
opined	□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
remarked	□□□□□□□ □□□
commented	□□□□□□□ □□□
observed	□□□□□□ / □□□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
expressed the view	□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
argued	□□□□ □□□
maintained	□□□□□ □□□□□ □□□□ □□□□

contended	□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□ □□□
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Example:

Direct: He said, “I think this plan is better.”

Indirect: He **opined** **that** that plan was better.

Nepali: □□□□ □□□□ □□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□□ □□□ □□□□□□ □□□□□□

4. Expressing Belief / □□□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□□□

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
believed	□□□□□□□ □□□
thought	□□□□
considered	□□□□ / □□□□
supposed	□□□□□□□ / □□□□□□□ □□□
assumed	□□□□□□ □□□
felt	□□□□□□ / □□□□
trusted	□□□□□□□ □□□

Example:

Direct: She said, “I believe that he is honest.”

Indirect: She **believed that** he was honest.

5. Expressing Knowledge / ज्ञान व्यक्त गर्ने वाक्यहरू

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
knew	जान्थे / जान्थ्यो
realized	जाने लाग्यो / बुझ्यो
understood	जान्थे
recognized	जाने लाग्यो / चिन्ने
remembered	जान्थे
recalled	जान्थे / सम्झ्यो

Example:

Direct: He said, “I know the truth.”

Indirect: He **said that he knew** the truth.

Note: Some verbs such as *knew*, *realized*, and *understood* are used according to the actual meaning of the sentence, not mechanically as replacements for *said*.

6. Expressing Certainty / □□□□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□□□

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
affirmed	□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
confirmed	□□□□□□ □□□
assured	□□□□□□□ □□□□
asserted	□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□ □□□
insisted	□□□ □□□
emphasized	□□□ □□□
guaranteed	□□□□□□□□□□□□ / □□□□□□□□□□ □□□

Example:

Direct: He said, “I am telling the truth.”

Indirect: He **affirmed that** he was telling the truth.

7. Expressing Agreement / □□□□□ □□□□□□□

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
agreed	□□□□ □□

accepted	□□□□□□□ □□□
admitted	□□□□□□□ □□□
conceded	□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□ □□□
acknowledged	□□□□□□□□/□□□□□□□ □□□
concurred	□□□□ □□

Example:

Direct: Ram said, “You are right.”

Indirect: Ram **agreed that** I was right.

8. Expressing Disagreement / □□□□□□ □□□□□□□

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
disagreed	□□□□□ □□
denied	□□□□□□□□ □□□
contradicted	□□□□□ □□□
objected	□□□□□□ □□□□
refuted	□□□ □□□□□ □□□□□ □□□□□ □□□
disputed	□□□□□□/□□□□□□ □□□□

Example:

Direct: He said, “I did not steal the money.”

Indirect: He **denied that** he had stolen the money.

9. Expressing Admission / □□□□□ □□ □□□□ □□□□□□□□ □□□□□

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
admitted	□□□□□□□□ □□□
confessed	□□□□□□□□ □□□ / □□□□□ □□□
acknowledged	□□□□□□□□ □□□
conceded	□□□□□□□□ □□□□ □□□□□ □□

Example:

Direct: He said, “I made a mistake.”

Indirect: He **admitted that** he had made a mistake.

10. Expressing Denial / □□□□□□□□□ □□□□□

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
denied	□□□□□□□ / □□□□□□□□□ □□□

rejected	□□□□□□□□ □□□
refuted	□□□□□ □□□
disclaimed	□□□□ □□□□□□□□ □□□

Example:

Direct: She said, “I have not broken the window.”

Indirect: She **denied that** she had broken the window.

11. Expressing Regret / □□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□□□

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
regretted	□□□□□ □□□□□ / □□□
expressed regret	□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
apologized	□□□□ □□□□

Example:

Direct: He said, “I am sorry for my mistake.”

Indirect: He **expressed regret for** his mistake.

12. Expressing Happiness / □□□□ □□□□□□ □□□□□

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
expressed happiness	खुसीको भाव व्यक्त गर्नु
rejoiced	खुसी हुनु
celebrated	खुसीको साथ मनाउनु
exclaimed with joy	खुसीको साथ जोरले भनिनु

Example:

Direct: She said, “I have passed the exam.”

Indirect: She **expressed happiness that** she had passed the exam.

13. Expressing Sadness / दुःखको भाव व्यक्त गर्नु

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
expressed sadness	दुःखको भाव व्यक्त गर्नु
lamented	दुःखको साथ शोक गर्नु / दुःखको साथ भनिनु
mourned	दुःखको साथ मनाउनु
grieved	दुःखको साथ दुःखिनु
exclaimed with sorrow	दुःखको साथ जोरले भनिनु

14. Expressing Surprise / □□□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□□□

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
expressed surprise	□□□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□
wondered	□□□□□ □□□□/□□□□
exclaimed with surprise	□□□□□□□□□□ □□□ □□□□□□ □□□

Example:

Direct: He said, “What a beautiful place it is!”

Indirect: He **exclaimed with surprise** **that** it was a very beautiful place.

15. Expressing Fear / □□ □□□□□□ □□□□□

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
feared	□□□□
expressed fear	□□ □□□□□□ □□□
was afraid	□□□□□□ □□□
was frightened	□□□□□ □□

Example:

Direct: He said, “I am afraid that I may fail.”

Indirect: He **feared that** he might fail.

16. Expressing Hope / ☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
hoped	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
wished	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ / ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
looked forward to	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Example:

Direct: She said, “I hope that I will succeed.”

Indirect: She **hoped that** she would succeed.

17. Expressing Doubt / ☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
doubted	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
questioned	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ / ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

wondered

□□□□□□ □□□□ □□□

Example:

Direct: He said, “I doubt whether he will come.”

Indirect: He **doubted whether** he would come.

18. Making a Claim / □□□□ □□□□□

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
claimed	□□□□ □□□
asserted	□□□□□□□□□□□□ □□□□ □□□
alleged	□□□□ / □□□□ □□□
maintained	□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□□ □□□
contended	□□□□□□□□ □□□□ □□□

Example:

Direct: He said, “I am the rightful owner.”

Indirect: He **claimed that** he was the rightful owner.

19. Emphasizing / □□□ □□□□□

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
emphasized	□□□ □□□
stressed	□□□ □□□
highlighted	□□□□□ □□□□□□□ □□□
underlined	□□□□□ □□□ □□□
pointed out	□□□□□□□

Example:

Direct: The teacher said, “Regular practice is important.”

Indirect: The teacher **emphasized that** regular practice was important.

20. Complaining / □□□□□□ □□□□□

Reporting Verb	Nepali Meaning
complained	□□□□□□ □□□
grumbled	□□□□ □□□
protested	□□□□□ / □□□□□□ □□□□
objected	□□□□□□ □□□□

Example:

Direct: He said, “The room is too noisy.”

Indirect: He **complained that** the room was too noisy.

Important Structures

A. Most common structure

Subject + reporting verb + that + reported clause

He said, “I am busy.”

→ He **said that** he was busy.

B. With a person/object

Subject + reporting verb + object + that + clause

He said to me, “You are honest.”

→ He **told me that** I was honest.

C. Some reporting verbs take special prepositions

Verb	Structure
apologize	apologize for + V-ing/noun
complain	complain about + noun/V-ing

insist	insist on + V-ing/noun
object	object to + V-ing/noun
agree	agree with + person / agree to + noun
congratulate	congratulate someone on + noun/V-ing
accuse	accuse someone of + V-ing
admit	admit + V-ing/that-clause
deny	deny + V-ing/that-clause

☆ Key Point

Do not select a reporting verb simply because the sentence is assertive.

Select it according to the speaker's intended meaning.

Reporting verb should convey the speaker's exact intention, not merely replace *said*.

For example:

- **He said that he was ill.** → simple statement

- . **He informed me that he was ill.** → giving information
- . **He admitted that he was ill.** → accepting a fact
- . **He claimed that he was ill.** → making a claim
- . **He complained that he was ill.** → expressing a complaint
- . **He feared that he was ill.** → expressing fear
- . **He believed that he was ill.** → expressing belief